

BOOKS AT HOME

Library cards and books for your child



Here is how to get books for home in Independence and nearby, and what changed with the Imagination Library.

About Dolly Parton's Imagination Library

Missouri's program is not taking new sign-ups. Missouri's education department (DESE) says that beginning July 1, 2026 the program does not have the funds to accept new applications. Children already enrolled keep getting books as funding allows. No reopening date has been announced. Questions: ImaginationLibrary@dese.mo.gov or 573-751-8751.

Live in Kansas? The Kansas program is open to any Kansas child from birth to their 5th birthday: imaginationlibraryks.org

1. Get a library card

Mid-Continent Public Library (mymcpl.org) serves Independence.

- Who can register: residents of the library's area and nearby counties, including Jackson County, Missouri, and Johnson and Wyandotte counties, Kansas
- A parent or legal guardian registers a child younger than 13
- Register online for online books right away. To borrow books, show a photo ID at any branch

2. Join 1000 Books Before Kindergarten

A free library program for any child from birth until they start kindergarten.

- Log books online, on a printable log, or on a log from a branch
- Collect a certificate at every 100 books
- Brothers and sisters who have not started kindergarten can each have their own log

3. Visit a storytime

Grow A Reader storytimes at the library include storytimes for babies, toddlers, preschoolers and families, and sensory-sensitive storytimes. Times change, so check the schedule at mymcpl.org first.

4. Read with the friends

Ask the questions from Futures Friends Story Time with any library book: What do you see? What happens next? How does this character feel?

MID-CONTINENT PUBLIC LIBRARY BRANCHES IN INDEPENDENCE

Branch	Address	Phone
East Independence	4505 Little Blue Parkway, Independence, MO 64057	(816) 503-4100
North Independence	317 W. 24 Hwy., Independence, MO 64050	(816) 252-0950
South Independence	13700 E. 35th St. South, Independence, MO 64055	(816) 461-2050
Farview Neighborhood Library	18109 E 12th St N, Independence, MO 64056	(816) 252-0951

☐ We registered for a library card ☐ We started our 1000 Books log ☐ We went to a storytime

Sources (all accessed 2026-10-05): DESE, Dolly Parton's Imagination Library of Missouri: dese.mo.gov/childhood/outreach/dolly-partons-imagination-library. Kansas program: imaginationlibraryks.org. Library card: mymcpl.org/about/get-help/get-a-library-card. 1000 Books: mymcpl.org/kids/early-learners/1000-books. Storytimes: mymcpl.org/kids/early-learners/storytimes. Branches: mymcpl.org/locations. **For our team:** centers can ask for Reading Rocket storytimes and kits at mymcpl.org/kids/reading-rocket. Futures Friends is not affiliated with these programs.

